person. Sergeant McCready and Paxto, together with Sub-Inspectors Hans Raj and Prem Chand, then took the men away, who offered no resistance.[2]

It had worked exactly as Bhagat Singh and B.K. Dutt had intended. And, their timing was particularly apt. Two bills were being debated on the floor of the house. Both had raised considerable concern in the popular press. Both were widely castigated as needless repressive measures by a paranoid oppressive government determined to suppress basic freedoms of the people of India. One was designed to quell and subjugate labour unrest. The other, introduced in the interests of 'public safety', was to do with banning the entry of those Communist Party members who came to India from abroad. Once again the fear of a communist revolution in India on the crest of a thunderously successful Bolshevik revolution in Russia during the past decade had unnerved the British government to its foundations and made them deeply wary of such movements. Both labour rights and the right to engage with the leading socialist thinkers had been the subject of considerable discussion in the nationalist press for some days. For Bhagat Singh and B.K. Dutt, their purpose, in creating such a calamitous spectacle in the Delhi Assembly, was to 'make the deaf hear'. Their leaflets could not have made this any more abundantly clear. They were 'to make a loud noise'. And they succeeded. The news spread instantly.

With it, just as instantly, followed fame. Bhagat Singh was fond of drinking milk. He relished buffalo milk in particular. Heavier and richer than cow's milk, it is renowned for its creaminess. Kiron Das, the younger brother of Jatin Das who was to die in Lahore Jail on 13 September 1929 after sixty-three days on hunger strike, recalls the time when Bhagat Singh spent a night with Jatin Das in his Hazara Road Mess, with the aim of learning from him how to make the bombs. At dawn, Bhagat Singh had upon awakening glimpsed from his bedroom window a man milking his buffalo on the other side of the road. Springing out of his bed, he had rushed out to the milkman, grabbed 'the full bucket of milk without caring to boil the same and paid him one rupee as price for the milk consumed' and gulped the contents of the bucket right down. Having paid the milkman, Bhagat Singh may have thought that to be the end of the matter. This it may